

Guinness World Records Down Under

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 4 English — Reading

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY05

Learning Intention

I am learning to use comprehension strategies to interpret and analyse an informative text.

Success Criteria

- I can identify the main idea and supporting details.
- I can compare facts described in the text.
- I can make inferences using evidence from the text.

Guinness World Records Down Under

Australia may be a relatively small country by population, but it holds an impressive number of record-breaking titles in the Guinness World Records book.

One of Australia's most famous records belongs to the Big Banana in Coffs Harbour, New South Wales. Built in 1964, it was the very first "Big Thing" built in Australia, sparking a trend of giant novelty structures across the country, including the Big Prawn, the Big Merino and the Big Pineapple.

Australia is also home to the world's largest sandstone monolith: Uluru, located in the Northern Territory. Uluru stands 348 metres tall and stretches 9.4 kilometres around its base, and it holds deep cultural significance for the Anangu people, the traditional owners of the land.

In the animal world, Australia holds the record for the most venomous snake on Earth: the inland taipan. A single bite from an inland taipan contains enough venom to kill 100 fully grown men, although the snake is shy and rarely encountered by humans in the wild.

Even Australia's road network holds a record. The Eyre Highway, which crosses the Nullarbor Plain, includes the longest straight stretch of road in the country — running dead straight for 146.6 kilometres without a single bend.

From giant fruit sculptures to record-breaking snakes, Australia's list of world records shows just how much this country stands out on the world stage — in ways both impressive and unexpected.

Part A — Comprehension Questions

Q1. What was Australia's first 'Big Thing' structure? _____

Q2. In which state or territory is Uluru located? _____

Q3. True or False: The inland taipan is the most venomous snake on Earth. _____

Q4. How tall does the text say Uluru stands? _____

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Part B — More Comprehension Questions

Q5. Name 2 other 'Big Things' mentioned in the text, besides the Big Banana.

1. _____ 2. _____

Q6. How long is the longest straight stretch of the Eyre Highway?

Q7. Who are the traditional owners of the land where Uluru is located?

Part C — Challenge: Think Deeper

A travel company wants to create a road trip itinerary visiting 3 of Australia's record-breaking sites mentioned in the text.

Q8. Choose 3 record-breaking sites from the text and explain why each would be interesting to visit.

Q9. The text describes the inland taipan's record as being 'both impressive and unexpected.' Explain why a dangerous snake being a 'record' might be seen this way.

Q10. Explain why it is important for the text to mention that Uluru holds 'deep cultural significance,' not just its size record.

Answer Key — Part A & B

A1: The Big Banana in Coffs Harbour.

A2: The Northern Territory.

A3: True — the inland taipan is the most venomous snake on Earth.

A4: 348 metres tall.

A5: The Big Prawn and the Big Merino (accept the Big Pineapple).

A6: 146.6 kilometres.

A7: The Anangu people.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: Any reasonable selection of 3 sites with a text-supported reason for each (e.g. Uluru for its size and cultural importance, the Big Banana for its novelty and history, the Eyre Highway for its unique record-breaking straight road) — teacher to check.

C9: 'Impressive' because it shows Australia has extreme, record-breaking wildlife, but 'unexpected' because most people wouldn't think of a dangerous, potentially deadly trait as something to be proud of or highlight as a record.

C10: Mentioning cultural significance shows Uluru is not just an impressive natural structure to look at, but a deeply important, meaningful site to the Anangu people, helping readers understand and respect it beyond just its record-breaking size.